Bhutan responded with an embargo on cross-border trade and forged closer links with India.

## INDO-TIBET BOUNDARY (EASTERN SECTOR)

As we've seen before, when the McMahon Line was drawn in 1914 along the crest of the Himalayan ranges separating Tibet from northeast India by following the watershed principle; the Tibetan representative, Lonchen Shatra, had received the consent of the thirteenth Dalai Lama and the Tibetan Kashag before signing the agreement. For the Chinese to dispute this boundary alignment subsequently was a clever distortion of history. After the collapse of the Qing dynasty in 1911, Tibetan troops had driven the ambans out of Lhasa. In a communiqué to the United Nations in 1960, the present Dalai Lama had stated: 'Whatever the position of Tibet may be prior to 1911-1912, in any event from the day the 13th Dalai Lama proclaimed the independence of Tibet, after the invading Chinese armies had been driven out of Tibet, Tibet was not only independent de facto but de jure.'

In the east, the frontier stretches across the rugged Assam Himalayas over 1,100 kilometres, extending from Bhutan in the west to the Sino-Myanmar border in the east. While the Indian position is based on the boundary line running along the crest of the Himalayas, the Chinese claim line runs along the base of the foothills. The entire area between these two lines encompasses 83,000 square kilometres.

As per the Chinese, the area between the foothills and the McMahon Line is divided into three parts: Monyul, Layul and Lower Tsayul. During the time of the second Dalai Lama, the Monyul area had an inseparable alliance with Tibet. In the middle of the seventeenth century, these ties were further strengthened under the fifth Dalai Lama. That was also the time when the Tawang Monastery was expanded and registered in the Dgondeb (register of monasteries). The Tawang Monastery was given definite administrative and religious powers, such as appointing lower ranking officials, levying of taxes and implementing the monk service system (offering the second among three sons to serve as a lama).

The Chinese draw reference to a plethora of Tibetan documents, most of them quasi-religious in nature, that claim the region even south of the foothills in this case. In 1942, the local Tibetan government ordered an inspection tour of the borders. The report said: 'The area from Amra Tala of